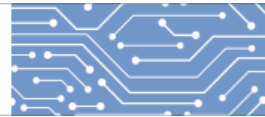


KLA Corp. (KLAC): Communacopia + Technology 2026 — Key Takeaways

Communacopia + Technology

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Explore >



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Presenters: Ahmad Khan, President, Semiconductor Products and Customers; Bren Higgins, EVP & CFO

Bottom Line: We have three key takeaways: (1) KLA management continues to believe WFE spending will grow at a similar or accelerated pace next year; (2) Within this envelope of spending, KLA believes it can also grow its revenue at a similar or faster rate in 2027, with steady increases in process control intensity over time; (3) Advanced packaging represents a structural tailwind for the company, and KLA expects to take incremental share over time; (4) Management expects its US market share to be similar or higher than its global share, especially in light of new market entrants ramping capacity, where process control is critically important.

Key Takeaways

- **WFE growth:** Despite some moving pieces, KLA management continues to maintain the view that WFE will grow at a similar or higher rate (mid-20%) to ~\$190 bn in 2027. For 2026, KLA believes the industry is set to grow to the low-\$150 bn range and added that its large backlog and longer lead times are providing improving visibility into growth for 2027 and beyond.
- **Deployment of AI:** Management discussed the redesign of its compute architecture for image processing and noted that its move to GPU-based compute has driven improved system performance and cost efficiency. Internally, KLA noted that it sees compelling early efficiency gains in its engineering department from implementing AI.
- **Process control intensity:** From a process control intensity perspective, KLA is set to benefit from the industry's transition to larger die sizes, higher transistor counts, and a generally more dynamic environment. Going forward, KLA struck a positive tone on its market share with new entrants in the US, for whom it emphasized the importance of yields.

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- **Advanced packaging:** Management maintained an upbeat tone on the advanced packaging opportunity as chip complexity, bandwidth needs, and sampling rates continue to grow. KLA noted that it controls a majority of the advanced packaging process control market (50%-60%) and highlighted the importance of process control for yield management in advanced packaging.
- **HBM process control:** As HBM continues to grow in complexity with higher layer counts, KLA stands to gain from the greater need for process control. Notably, management added that the process control intensity in HBM matches that of advanced logic in some iterations, and it sees the introduction of hybrid bonding in HBM as a structural tailwind.
- **China:** KLA noted that China represents ~25% of its business and that it expects that share of its revenue to decline modestly over time. Management believes that China may return to growth next year but will grow at a lower pace than other parts of its business.

Valuation/Risks

KLA (Neutral): Our price target is \$210, which is based on a 32X P/E multiple applied to our normalized EPS of \$6.50. Key upside/downside risks: (1) sharp increase in Foundry/Logic spending; (2) uncertainty related to export restrictions were to be removed; (3) sharp rebound in Memory WFE spending (vis-a-vis Foundry/Logic); (4) incremental US export restrictions.

KLAC	12m Price Target: \$210.00	Price: \$177.18	Upside: 18.5%
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Neutral		GS Forecast			
Market cap: \$233.4bn Enterprise value: \$236.7bn 3m ADTV: \$2.7bn United States Americas Semiconductors & IT Services M&A Rank: 3	Revenue (\$ mn)	6/25	6/26	6/27E	6/28E
	EBITDA (\$ mn)	12,156.2	13,579.5	18,425.4	21,472.0
	EBIT (\$ mn)	5,332.8	5,948.6	8,679.4	10,209.8
	EPS (\$)	5,241.0	5,850.5	8,574.9	10,098.9
	P/E (X)	3.33	3.76	5.58	6.61
	EV/EBITDA (X)	22.0	36.8	31.7	26.8
	FCF yield (%)	19.1	31.4	27.0	22.4
	Dividend yield (%)	3.8	2.1	2.5	3.6
	Net debt/EBITDA (X)	0.9	0.6	0.6	0.7
		0.7	0.7	0.4	0.1
	EPS (\$)	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
		1.05	1.25	1.41	1.45

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 10 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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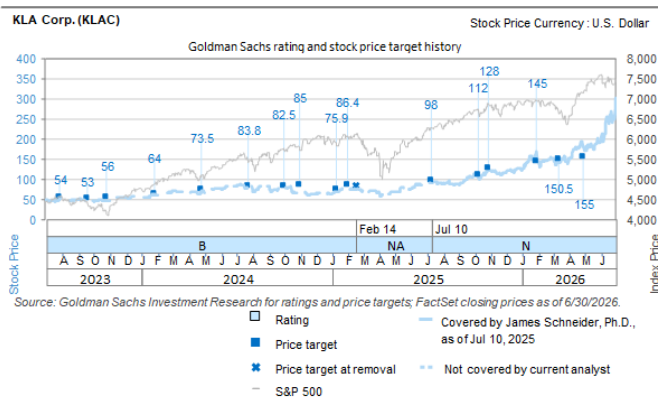
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KLA Corp. (KLAC)

Date of report Target price (\$) Closing price (\$)

29-Jul-26	210.00	170.19
05-Jul-26	230.00	235.55
29-Apr-26	1,550.00	181.62
13-Mar-26	1,505.00	141.86
30-Jan-26	1,450.00	142.79
29-Oct-25	1,280.00	123.53
08-Oct-25	1,120.00	106.26
10-Jul-25	980.00	92.86
31-Jan-25	864.00	73.82
10-Jan-25	759.00	68.31
31-Oct-24	850.00	66.62
02-Oct-24	825.00	77.74
25-Jul-24	838.00	76.28
26-Apr-24	735.00	70.63
26-Jan-24	640.00	59.94
26-Oct-23	560.00	45.82
19-Sep-23	530.00	45.73

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